

NOUN

A noun is a part of speech that represents a person, place, thing, idea, or concept.

Kinds of Nouns :-

1. Proper Noun
2. Common Noun
3. Collective Noun
4. Material Noun
5. Abstract Noun

(1) Proper Noun :-

A proper noun is a name which refers only to a single person, place, or thing and there is no common name for it. In written English, a proper noun always begins with capital letters.

Examples :- Delhi, Yamuna, Rohit, The Taj Mahal

(2) Common Noun :- A **common noun** is a name for something which gives common or general identity to a thing, person, or place.

Examples :- boy, girl, town, river, country etc.

(3) Collective Noun :- It is a group denoting word. It can be used to denote 'undivided whole/unit' or members of the group.

Examples :- Committee, clergy, group, family, flock, public, team, army, battalion, audience, shoal, crowd, galaxy, series, gang, crew etc.

Note :- A collective noun can be **Singular or Plural**, depending on how you see the individuals in the group.

If you see the **individuals acting together**, as a whole, then you treat the collective noun as singular (with singular verbs and singular pronouns).

Examples :- The team was given a standing ovation for winning the cricket match. (The team is seen as singular, so the singular verb 'was' has been used.)

If you see the **members of a group acting individually**, then you treat the collective noun as plural (with plural verbs and plural pronouns).

Examples :-

- The jury **have** not reached a conclusion because they are still arguing among themselves. (The jury is seen as plural, so plural verb 'have' has been used.)

(4) Material Noun :- A material noun is a word for a material, a substance, or an ingredient that other things are made from.

Examples :- concrete, cotton, gold, iron, meat, milk, rice, coffee etc.

- The bag is made of **cloth**.
- **Gold** jewellery is very popular in India.

Material Noun is considered uncountable **and we use a singular verb with them. We do not use any article before them.**

(5) Abstract Noun :-

An abstract noun is a word which names something that you cannot see, hear, touch, smell, or taste. It talks about quality, concept, state, feeling, emotion etc. It has no physical existence. It can only be experienced.

Examples :- Consideration, parenthood, belief, joy, love, honesty, hatred etc.

Most words ending in **ness/hood/ship/ty/th** are abstract nouns.

Examples :- childhood, freshness, integrity, duty, friendship, courtship, membership etc.

Nouns can further be divided into :-

(A) Countable :-

The nouns that can be counted and made plural are called countable nouns. Countable nouns can take any article: *a, an, the*.

Examples :- Boy, Girl, chair, table etc.

(B) Uncountable :-

The nouns that cannot be counted and cannot be made plural are called uncountable nouns. Uncountable nouns can take only article 'the' and not a/an.

Examples :- information, bread, news, advice, luggage, furniture etc.

IMPORTANT RULES REGARDING USAGE OF NOUNS :-

RULE 1 :- These nouns are always plural and a plural verb is used with them.

Headphones, knickers, premises (buildings), alms, ruins, amends, archives, arrears, auspices, congratulations, embers, fireworks, lodgings, outskirts, particulars, proceeds, regards, riches, remains, savings, shambles, surroundings, tidings, furnishings, earnings, leftovers, troops, tactics, thanks, valuables, forceps, wages, belongings, braces, scissors, tongs, pliers, pincers, bellows, trousers, pants, tights, pyjamas, shorts, gallows, fangs, spectacles, goggles, binoculars, eyeglasses, whereabouts, obsequies.

Examples :-

- The **scissors** which are used by you are mine.
- Your **clothes** are dirty.
- Have you seen my **glasses** ? I want to read the newspaper.
- The table of **contents** should not contain any pictures.
- **Firearms** were used to disperse the crowd.
- I live on the **outskirts** of the city.
- We should keep our **surroundings** neat and clean.

Note :- Some of these nouns are often used with the expression "a pair of", as they refer to things made up of two parts.

- a pair of trousers
- a pair of jeans
- a pair of shoes
- a pair of slippers
- a pair of glasses
- a pair of gloves
- a pair of earrings
- a pair of socks

Note :- With "a pair of", a singular verb will be used.

Example :- He has bought a wonderful **pair of** shoes.

RULE 2 :- These nouns appear to be plural but are actually singular and we use a singular verb with them.

Examples :- news, innings, politics, summons, linguistics etc.

Names of subjects ending with "s".

Examples :- Physics, Economics, Civics, Mathematics etc.

Names of diseases ending with "s".

Examples :- Diabetes, Rabies, Mumps, Measles, Shingles, etc.

Names of games ending with "s".

Examples :- Billiards, Athletics, Dominoes, Draughts, etc.

Note :- Articles are not used with these nouns and s/es can not be removed from these nouns.

Examples :-

- **Athletics is** good for young people.
- Sapna has been suffering from **Diabetes**.
- **Linguistics is** the study of language.
- **Darts is** a popular game in England.
- **Billiards is** played all over the world.

RULE 3 :- These nouns appear to be singular but are plural and a plural verb is used with them - cattle, cavalry, infantry, poultry, peasantry, children, gentry, police, people, clergy, folk, vermin, etc.

Examples :-

- The gentry of our colony **are** sagacious.
- The police **are** saluting the minister.

RULE 4 :- These nouns are used in singular form only and they are uncountable nouns only.

Scenery, Poetry, Furniture, Advice, Information, Hair, Business, Mischief, Bread, Stationery, Crockery, Luggage, Baggage, Postage, Knowledge, Wastage, Money, Jewellery, Breakage, Equipment, Work, Evidence, Word, Fuel, Bedding, soap, butter, Milk, Rice, Sugar, Cash, filth, plastic, rubber etc.

Examples :-

- The scenery is very beautiful.
- I need some **equipment** to repair the damage.

Note :- [We cannot use a/an with these nouns immediately before them. To express a quantity of an uncountable noun ,i.e to make the singular or plural of the noun, we use a word or expression like **some, a lot of, much, a bit of, a great deal of, kind of.**]

Examples :-

- He gave me **a great deal of** advice before my interview.
- Can you give me **some** information about uncountable nouns?
- He did not have **much** sugar left.
- **A lot of** wonderful jewellery was available in the shop.
- **A piece of** jewellery is here for you.

Note :- The verb used varies as per the usage of the noun.

RULE 5 :-

Hair : Be careful with the noun **hair** which is normally uncountable in English, so it is not used in the plural. It can be countable only when referring to individual hairs.

Examples :-

- Her hair is straight.
- Your three hairs are black.
- There is a hair in the rice.

Paper :- When **paper** refers to exams it is countable otherwise it is singular.

Examples :-

- A lot of paper is used in the offices.
- I have to answer two English papers in May.

RULE 6 :- These nouns are in the **same form** in singular and plural.

Means, Headquarters, Barracks, Offspring, innings, crossroads, Deer, sheep, series, species, fish, crew, jury, aircraft, counsel etc.

Examples :-

- **A deer** was seen in the park.
- **Two deer** were seen in the park.
- Deer **are** grazing in the field.
- The **headquarters** of IDBI bank **is** situated in Mumbai.

RULE 7 :- [The + common noun] acts as an abstract noun and denotes that quality or characteristic.

Examples :-

- It is **the** animal in Mr. Pardeep that makes him commit such a heinous crime.
(‘The animal’ means qualities of an animal, not the actual animal.)
- **A** mother in Shweta is still alive. (**Incorrect**).
- **The** mother in Shweta is still alive. (**Correct**). (‘The mother’ means motherhood or the qualities of a mother)

RULE 8 :- For nouns ending in “**ful**”, add “**s**” to “**ful**” to make it plural.

Examples :- Cupful - Cupfuls (Correct), Cupsful (**Incorrect**)

Teaspoonfuls, cupfuls, handfuls, glassfuls

RULE 9 :- Half : Be careful with the word **half** which is always used in the following format:

- A + half + noun
- Half + a/an + noun
- Number + and a half + Plural noun
- Number (a/an/two...) + noun + and a half

Examples :-

- Rachna will have to cover one km and a half in thirty minutes. (**Incorrect**).
- Rachna will have to cover a km and a half in thirty minutes. (**Correct**).
- One and a half glass of milk will be sufficient for our baby. (**Incorrect**)
- One and a half glasses of milk will be sufficient for our baby. (**Correct**)

RULE 10 :- Hyphenated noun:

Expressions such as **a ten-rupee note, a two-mile walk, a five-year-old child, a three-day workshop, a twenty-man committee** are treated as singular. We don't pluralize them. Hyphenated words are not pluralized.

Examples :-

- I attended **a three-days** workshop. (**Incorrect**) (use three-day workshop)
- A **three-member** committee was formed to look into the matter. (**Correct**)

RULE 11 :- When words like **dozen, hundred, million, billion** are used with a number, we use them in singular form.

Examples :-

- There are four dozen bananas in this basket. (**Correct**)
- There are four dozens bananas in this basket. (**Incorrect**)
- There are four dozens of bananas in this basket. (**Incorrect**)
- There are more than eight billion people in the world. (**Correct**)
- There are more than eight billions people in the world. (**Incorrect**)

Exception :- But if we use **Indefinite countable** with them then we can **make them plural**. Like dozens of men, thousands of people, millions of stars, etc.

Examples :-

- Elon musk spends **millions of** dollars on his ambitious projects.
- **Hundreds of** people gathered on the streets to protest against the new bill.

Note :- With **pair** and **score**, we use '**of**' and the plural form is used when there is more than one pair or score.

Examples :-

- I bought **a pair of** shoes for the party. (**Correct**)
- I bought **three pairs of** socks for my daughter. (**Correct**)
- The shopkeeper gave me **three scores of** pencils for two hundred rupees. (**Correct**)
- The fruit vendor gave me **a score of** kiwis for one thousand rupees. (**Correct**)

RULE 12 :-

"The + adjective" like **"the poor", "the blind", "the deaf" etc.**, are always plural. We don't make their plural forms by adding "s" to them. And also, in place of **"the + adjective's + noun"**, **"the noun of the adjective"** is used.

Examples :-

- **The poor** need to work too hard to meet their basic needs. ('The poor' is plural, so plural verb 'need' will be used)
- **The poor's plight** is very pathetic in the USA. (**Incorrect**)
- **The plight of the poor** is very pathetic in the USA. (**Correct**)

RULE 13 :- The + plural surname denotes a whole family and a plural verb is used with it.

Example :-

- The Sharmas **have** been living here for many years.

RULE 14 :- There are certain nouns which are used by Indians while speaking but they are incorrect.

Example :-

- What is your **good name?** (Incorrect)
What is your **name?** (Correct)

S.N.	Incorrect	Correct
1.	Cousin brother/sister	Cousin
2.	The teacher of English	English teacher
3.	Pickpocket	Pickpocket
4.	Good name	Name
5.	Big blunder	Blunder
6.	Members of the family	Family members
7.	Years back	Years ago
8.	Out of station	Out of town
9.	Cinema (Building)	Movie
10.	Prepone	Reschedule

RULE 15 :-

If the same noun is used before and after a preposition , both the nouns should be in singular form, and a singular verb will be used.

Examples :-

- **Day after day.** (Correct)
- Days after days. (Incorrect)
- **City after city** was swept away by the flood. (Correct)
- **Letter after letter** was sent by the department. (Correct)
- He went **door to door** in search of water. (Correct)

RULE 16 :- There are some nouns that are common for both the genders like **student, teacher, child, advocate, worker, clerk, leader, musician, cousin, driver, friend, teenager**, etc. They are used for both Male and Female Genders. These kinds of nouns are used as **singular** and generally: **he/his/him** are used after them.

Examples :-

- "My mom works at school. She is a teacher." (Here teacher refers to **mom and she**, therefore, refers to a **feminine noun**.)
- "My dad works at school. He is a teacher." (Here teacher refers to **dad and he**, therefore, refers to a **masculine noun**.)

RULE 17 :-**Types of Noun-Gender :**

1 - Masculine Gender :- A noun that represents a male is known as the masculine gender, like- Boy, man, lion, King, father, son etc.

2 - Feminine Gender :- A noun that represents a female is known as the feminine gender, like-girl, woman, lioness, sister, mother, earth, goddess etc.

3 - Common Gender :- A noun that represents both males and females is known as the common gender, like- child, baby, teacher, servant, guest, infant, owner, parent, etc.

4 - Neuter Gender :- A noun that represents a thing that is non-living is called a neuter gender. All non-living objects fall into this category, like-box, chair, chalk, butter, room ,book , copy, etc.

RULES FOR CHANGING MASCULINE NOUN TO FEMININE NOUN:

RULE (i) :- Masculine can be changed into feminine by adding 'ess'.

Examples :-

Prince - Princess
Host - Hostess

Lion - Lioness
Tailor - Tailoress

RULE (ii) :- Some masculine nouns end in a **vowel + r**. They can be changed into feminine gender by adding ‘-ess’ and removing the ‘vowel before the last letter’.

Examples :-

Actor	-	Actress	Waiter	-	Waitress
Founder	-	Foundress	Hunter	-	Huntress

RULE (iii) :- Masculine can be changed into the feminine by using a completely different word.

Examples :-

King	-	Queen	Dog	-	Bitch
Son	-	Daughter	Boy	-	Girl

RULE (iv) :-

Feminine of the compound noun is made by changing the masculine word for the compound noun that comes in the front.

Examples :-

He-bear	-	She-bear	Jack-ass	-	Jenny-ass
Peacock	-	Peahen	Grandson	-	Granddaughter
Gentleman	-	Gentlewoman	Landlord	-	Landlady
Headmaster	-	Headmistress	Manservant	-	Maidservant

RULE 18 :-

WORDS DENOTING GROUPS

1. An **army/ colony** of ants
2. An **armada/fleet** of ships
3. An **atlas** of maps
4. A **band** of musicians
5. A **batch** of letters
6. A **bundle** of sticks/ newspapers/ old clothes
7. A **board** of directors
8. A **bevy** of girls, women, officers etc.
9. A **brigade/troop** of soldiers
10. A **bunch** of grapes, keys, bananas etc.
11. A **caravan** of merchants, pilgrims, travellers
12. A **cast** of actors
13. A **coalition** of parties
14. A **chain/ range** of mountains/ islands or hills
15. A **choir** of singers
16. A **class/batch** of students
17. A **collection** of stamps
18. A **clump/ grove** of trees
19. A **cloud** of grasshoppers
20. A **code** of laws/ conduct
21. A **cluster/ constellation/ galaxy** of stars.
22. A **company/ regiment/ army** of soldiers.
23. A **congregation** in a religious place
24. A **course of/ series of** lectures
25. A **crew** of sailors
26. A **crowd/ mob of** people
27. A **curriculum** of studies
28. A **flight** of steps, stairs
29. A **fleet of** ships or motorcars
30. A **flock** of geese, sheep and birds
31. A **gaggle** of geese
32. A **grove** of trees
33. A **garland/bunch/bouquet** of flowers
34. A **heap** of ruins, sand, stones
35. A **herd** of cattle/ elephants
36. A **hive** of bees
37. A **hum** of bees
38. A **leap** of leopards

39. A **litter** of puppies/ pigs/ kittens
40. An **orchestra** of musicians
41. A **peal** of bells
42. A **pack** of hounds, cards, wolves, suitcase
43. A **pair** of shoes, scissors, compasses, trousers etc.
44. A **series** of events
45. A **sheaf** of corn
46. A **shoal or school** of fish
47. A **swarm** of ants, bees or flies
48. A **squad** of soldiers or police officers.
49. A **train** of carriages, followers etc.
50. A **troop** of horses (cavalry), scouts.
51. A **troupe** of performers.
52. A **tyranny** of dictators
53. A **wealth** of information
54. A **yoke** of oxen
55. A **volley** of shots, arrows, bullets

RULE 19 :-

NOUN-NUMBER (Singular-Plural)

Changing Singular to Plural:

RULE (i) :- We add "s" to the end of any noun to make it plural.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Horse	horses	Chair	chairs

RULE (ii) :- Nouns ending in **s, ss, ch, sh, z or x** add 'es' to make it plural.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Bus	Buses	Fox	Foxes
Bush	Bushes	Tax	Taxes
Switch	Switches	Quiz	Quizzes
Bench	Benches	Dish	Dishes

Exceptions :-

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Stomach	Stomachs	Radius	Radii
Locus	Loci	Ox	Oxen
Index	Indices		

RULE (iii) :- For Nouns ending in 'o' and preceded by a consonant we add 'es' to make it plural.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Hero	Heroes	Potato	Potatoes
Mosquito	Mosquitoes	Mango	Mangoes
Cargo	Cargoes	Echo	Echoes

Exceptions :-

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Dynamo	Dynamos	Piano	Pianos
Photo	Photos	Solo	Solos

RULE (iv) :- Nouns ending in **double vowels**, add "s".

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Tree	Trees	Bee	Bees
Radio	Radios	Zoo	Zoos
Portfolio	Portfolios		

RULE (v) :- For nouns ending in "y" and preceded by a consonant, remove "y" and add "ies".

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Cry	Cries	Country	Countries
Family	Families	Pony	Ponies
City	Cities	Lorry	Lorries
Reply	Replies		

RULE (vi) :- For nouns ending in "y" and preceded by a vowel, simply add "s".

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Key	Keys	Donkey	Donkeys
Ray	Rays	Monkey	Monkeys
Way	Ways	Valley	Valleys
Toy	Toys		

RULE (vii) :- For nouns ending in "f" or "fe". Remove f/fe and add "ves".

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Calf	Calves	Half	Halves
Wife	Wives	Thief	Thieves
Wolf	Wolves	Life	Lives
Leaf	Leaves	Knife	Knives
Shelf	Shelves	Loaf	Loaves

Exceptions :-

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Belief	Beliefs	Chief	Chiefs
Cliff	Cliffs	Dwarf	Dwarfs
Grief	Griefs	Gulf	Gulfs
Proof	Proofs	Roof	Roofs
Safe	Safes	Scarf	Scarfs
Turf	Turfs	Brief	Briefs

RULE (viii) :- For changing Compound Nouns to plural, make the main word plural. Do not add "s" to the end of the word.

Singular	Plural
Bedroom	Bedrooms
Commander-in-chief	Commanders-in-chief
Peacock	Peacocks
Brother-in-law	Brothers-in-law
Step-daughter	Step-daughters
Maid-servant	Maid-servants
Mother-in-law	Mothers-in-law
Sister-in-law	Sisters-in-law

RULE (ix) :-

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Man	Men	Woman	Women
Foot	Feet	Tooth	Teeth
Mouse	Mice	Louse	Lice
Goose	Geese	Oasis	Oases
Child	Children	Ox	Oxen

RULE 20 :-

Some Typical Plural Nouns (Number)

(a) **Latin words:** For words of Latin origin and ending in "um" change the "um" to "a".

Singular	Plural
Datum	Data
Ovum	Ova
Agendum	Agenda
Dictum	Dicta
Memorandum	Memoranda
Stratum	Strata
Addendum	Addenda
Corrigendum	Corrigenda

For some other latin words ending in "um" we simply add "s" to make it plural.

Singular	Plural
Auditorium	Auditoriums
Premium	Premiums
Asylum	Asylums
Museums	Museums
Aquarium	Aquariums

Mausoleum	Mausoleums
Forum	Forums
Pendulum	Pendulums

(b) For Latin words ending in "us" change the "us" to "i"

Singular	Plural
Radius	Radii
Syllabus	Syllabi
Focus	Foci
Cactus	Cacti

(c) For Greek words ending in "is", to make it Plural, "is" is changed to "es".

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Analysis	Analyses	Basis	Bases
Thesis	Theses	Hypothesis	Hypotheses
Crisis	Crises		

(d) For Greek words ending in "on", the "on" is changed to "a".

Singular	Plural
Phenomenon	Phenomena
Criterion	Criteria

(e) For abbreviations we simply add an "s" to the last alphabet.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
MP	MPs	VIP	VIPs

(f) For letters, digits and alphabets

- To make the plural of a single digit or a number, we simply add 's' at the end.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
5	5s	1990	1990s
0	0s	20	20s

- To make the plural of small case (or lowercase) letters, we add **apostrophe + s**

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
p	p's	s	s's

- To make the plural of a capital letter, an abbreviation, an acronym, an initialism, a symbol(#, @, %, etc), we simply add **s** without an apostrophe at the end.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
A	As	B	Bs
ABC	ABCs	MP3	MP3s
MLA	MLAs	MP	MPs
FAQ	FAQs	MRI	MRIs
#	#s	\$	\$s

(g) There are some adjectives, if we add "s"/"es" to these adjectives they become plural nouns.

Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Sweet	Sweets	Essential	Essentials
Valuable	Valuables	Explosive	Explosives
Good	Goods	Moveable	Moveables

RULE 21 :- The following compound nouns are always used in the plural form.

Human rights, current events, inverted commas, armed forces, natural resources, social studies, industrial relations, high heels.

Examples :-

- High heels cause discomfort.
- Current events of the past year are very important for the exam.
- Natural resources are not found in this part of the country.

RULE 22 :- There are some nouns; if we make them plural the meaning changes completely.

S.N.	Singular	Plural
1.	Spectacle (a visually striking performance)	Spectacles (a pair of glasses)

2.	Chain (a sequence of items of the same type forming a line)	Chains (a series of linked metal rings used for fastening or securing something, or for pulling loads.)
3.	Appearance (The way that someone or something looks)	Appearances (an act of performing or participating in a public event)
4.	Damage (Physical harm that impairs the value, usefulness, or normal function of something.)	damages (a sum of money claimed or awarded in compensation for a loss or an injury.)
5.	Ground (The solid surface of the earth)	grounds (basis)
6.	Custom (A tradition)	Customs (Customs duty- a tax imposed on imports and exports of goods.)
7.	Air (A gaseous substance)	Airs (Affected manners intended to impress)
8.	Return (come or go back to a place or person)	Returns (Income tax returns)
9.	Iron (A metal)	Irons (Fetters or chains)
10.	Force (Strength/ energy)	Forces (An organized body of military personnel or police.)
11.	Sand (A loose granular substance, typically pale yellowish brown)	Sands (A small desert)
12.	Wood (The hard fibrous material that forms the main substance of the trunk)	Woods (A small forest)
13.	Asset (Quality)	Assets (Property)
14.	Alphabet (a set of letters)	Alphabets (languages)
15.	Content (satisfaction)	Contents (Subject matters)
16.	Water	Waters (Ocean / Sea)

RULE 23 :-**Usage of Apostrophe ('s)**

i) An apostrophe is used to show **possession**.

To show **possession** with a **singular noun**, add an apostrophe plus the letter "s".

Examples :- a woman's responsibility, the boss's wife, that man's son, the dog's tail.

ii) Most nouns form their plurals by adding either the letter "s" or "es" (boy, boys; letter, letters; actress, actresses etc.) To show **plural possession**, simply put an apostrophe after the "s".

Correct: boys' night out (boy + s + apostrophe)

Incorrect: boy's night out (implies only one boy)

Correct: girls' hostel (girl + s + apostrophe)

Incorrect: girl's hostel

iii) With a **singular compound noun** (for example, mother-in-law), **show possession with an apostrophe + s** at the end of the word.

Example :-

- My **mother-in-law's** house

If the **compound noun** (e.g., brother-in-law) is to be made **plural**, form the **plural first** (brothers-in-law), and then use the apostrophe + s.

Example :-

- My two **brothers-in-law's** house

iv) If two people possess the same item, put the **apostrophe + s after the second name** only.

Example :-

- Ravi and Geeta's home is constructed of stone.

In cases of separate rather than joint possession, use the possessive form for both.

Example :-

- Ravi's and Geeta's homes are both lovely. (They don't own the homes jointly.)

v) Use an **apostrophe with contractions**. The apostrophe is placed where a letter or letters have been removed.

Examples :- doesn't, won't, it's, can't, you've, etc.

vi) The personal pronouns **hers, ours, yours, theirs, its, whose, and oneself** never take an apostrophe.

Examples :-

- Feed a horse grain. It's better for its health.
- Is this pen your's ? (**Incorrect**)
- Is this pen yours ? (**Correct**)

vii) **Apostrophe and s ('s) are used only for living things.** For non-living things, we use "of".

Examples :-

- The telephone's cable is damaged. (**Incorrect**)
- The cable of the telephone is damaged. (**Correct**)
- The child broke the table's leg. (**Incorrect**)
- The child broke the leg of the table. (**Correct**)

viii) We use 's in case of **personification**.

Example :- The **wind's song** hummed gently through the night, calming the world.

ix) **Idioms and phrases** also use 's.

- At one's wit's end.
- At an arm's length.

x) 's can also be used for **celestial bodies/planets** etc

Examples :-

- The Earth's rotation causes the cycle of day and night.
- The Moon's surface is covered in craters and dust.

xi) **Double apostrophe** is not to be used.

Examples :-

- My mother's friend's daughter has topped the exam. (**Incorrect**)
- The daughter of my mother's friend has topped the exam. (**Correct**)

xii) We can use 's with **Anybody/ Nobody/ Everybody/ Somebody/ Anyone/ Someone/ No one/ Everyone** .

Examples :-

- Everyone's responsibility is no one's responsibility.

If "else" has been used after these words, then 's will be used after "else".

- I can do only your work, not somebody else's.

It is incorrect to write "**somebody's else**", "**everybody's else**".

Practice Exercise

Directions :- In these questions, read each sentence to find out whether there is any error in it. The error, if any, will be in one part of the sentence. The number of that part is the answer, if there is no error the answer is (d). (Ignore errors of punctuation, if any.)

Q.1. (a) Rohit came/(b)with three /(c) cupsful of tea/(d) no error.

Q.2. (a) Rahul has given her/(b) thirty five millions dollars to /(c)buy a new house/(d) no error.

Q.3. (a) I gifted him/(b) many pair /(c)of shoes /(d) no error.

Q.4. (a) Deaf are/(b) demanding /(c) reservations in jobs/(d) no error.

Q.5. (a) The book's cover /(b) is highly /(c)glossy /(d) no error.

Q.6. (a) The scissors/(b) which is lying on the table /(c)can't be used now /(d) no error.

- Q.7. (a) Pair after pair /(b) of binoculars have been /(c) sent to Mr. Rajkumar /(d) no error.
- Q.8. (a) He received a/(b) summon to appear in court/(c) for the murder case /(d) no error.
- Q.9. (a) Mathematics play a critical /(b) role in various fields like /(c) science, engineering, and finance. /(d) no error.
- Q.10. (a) You will see that different people /(b) living in India/(c) have different cultures /(d) no error.
- Q.11. (a) Peoples /(b) toil and toil to earn /(c) their bread and butter /(d) no error.
- Q.12. (a) Can you give/(b) me your half hour/(c) to finish this work? /(d) no error.
- Q.13. (a) Three hundred rupees/(b) are not a reasonable price/(c) for this book/(d) no error.
- Q.14. (a) Payal is going/(b) to buy a four /(c) rooms flat tomorrow /(d) no error.
- Q.15. (a) Paramjeet/(b) respects a student/(c) in Karamveer /(d) no error.
- Q.16. (a) You should /(b) take care of/(c) the olds /(d) no error.
- Q.17. (a) The police /(b) has arrived on the spot /(c) on time /(d) no error.
- Q.18. (a) Rabies are/(b) a dangerous /(c) disease /(d) no error.
- Q.19. (a) Everything's beauty /(b) is difficult /(c) to define. /(d) no error.
- Q.20. (a) Poor are/(b) exploited by/(c) the rich /(d) no error.
- Q.21. (a) The brave/(b) is loved and respected all over/(c) the world /(d) no error.
- Q.22. (a) Her knickers,/(b) adorned with intricate lace patterns, /(c) was carefully folded in the drawer /(d) no error.
- Q.23. (a) The news are/(b) broadcast daily to keep the public informed/(c) about current events /(d) no error.
- Q.24. (a) Diabetes require /(b) careful management of blood sugar levels /(c) through medication and lifestyle changes /(d) no error.
- Q.25. (a) The gentry in the/(b) historic town have preserved their cultural /(c) heritage with great care /(d) no error.
- Q.26. (a) Cities after cities /(b) has witnessed significant development/(c) over the years /(d) no error.
- Q.27. (a) The twenty-men committee, /(b) comprising dedicated individuals from various backgrounds, collaborated seamlessly /(c) to organize the community event/(d) no error.
- Q.28. (a) The seven-feet-tall basketball player, /(b) known for his incredible slam dunks and defensive prowess, dominated/(c) the court during the championship game/(d) no error.
- Q.29. (a) All the informations /(b) imparted to me can't be /(c) used for this purpose /(d) no error.
- Q.30. (a) I have not gone through /(b) this history book, so i can not /(c) tell you anything about its content / (d) no error.
- Q.31. (a) Sweet voice / (b) is one of her /(c) beauty /(d) no error.
- Q.32. (a) Take off / (b) your cloths /(c) and have a bath /(d) no error.
- Q.33. (a) I don't /(b) like the /(c) government's policies / (d) no error.
- Q.34. (a) Sapna is not /(b) beautiful, but /(c) her hair are straight /(d) no error.
- Q.35. (a) This pair of /(b) spectacles /(c) are highly expensive /(d) no error.
- Q.36. (a) Have you ever /(b) seen such a beautiful /(c) shoal of fishes/(d) no error.
- Q.37. (a) I always / (b) have fruits /(c) in my breakfast /(d) no error.

- Q.38.** (a) She has to appear /(b) before the /(c) metropolis magistrate/(d) no error.
- Q.39.** (a) Pair after pair /(b)of shoes has been /(c) sent to him/(d) no error.
- Q.40.** (a) Are you talking /(b) about India /(c) and China's leaders? /(d) no error.
- Q.41.** (a) Mr. Rajkumar /(b) has five /(c) wives / (d) no error.
- Q.42.** (a) I asked /(b) the address /(c) many passer-bys /(d) no error.
- Q.43.** (a) Rachna has /(b) only five /(c) childs / (d) no error.
- Q.44.** (a) I need / (b) two spoonsful /(c) of sugar /(d) no error.
- Q.45.** (a) There are only two / (b) women doctor /(c) in the hospital /(d) no error.
- Q.46.** (a) Rachna's and Nancy's /(b) father is /(c) my uncle /(d) no error.
- Q.47.** (a) I was carrying /(b) someone's else /(c) bag /(d) no error.
- Q.48.** (a) Have you heard about /(b) my sister's in law husband/(c) in the news? /(d) no error.
- Q.49.** (a) All the peoples /(b) in North America /(c) are egoistic /(d) no error.
- Q.50.** (a) The leader, in the midst /(b) of a heated debate, defended /(c) his proposal with passion and eloquence /(d) no error.
- Q.51.** (a) Keep your valuable secure /(b) in the hotel safe while /(c) exploring the vibrant city /(d) no error.
- Q.52.** (a) Amidst the bustling city, the police, /(b)equipped with state-of-the-art technology /(c) is tirelessly working to ensure the safety of the diverse population. /(d) no error.
- Q.53.** (a) She bought /(b)a beautiful handmade paper /(c)to write a letter to her friend /(d) no error
- Q.54.** (a) The artist carefully /(b) selected different types of /(c) papers for her origami creations /(d) no error.
- Q.55.** (a) The blacksmith /(b) forged intricate designs /(c) using irons in his workshop /(d) no error.
- Q.56.** (a) The archaeologists discovered /(b) ancient artifacts buried /(c) in the grounds during the excavation /(d) no error.
- Q.57.** (a) Mary was at /(b) her wit end trying to fix /(c) the computer issue /(d) no error.
- Q.58.** (a) The two estranged friends kept each other /(b)at an arm length, reluctant to delve into the issues /(c)that had strained their relationship /(d) no error.
- Q.59.** (a) The Northern Lights, a breathtaking natural light /(b) display in the polar regions, is a remarkable /(c) phenomena that attracts tourists from around the world /(d) no error.
- Q.60.** (a) Ram, Shyam and Rahim /(b) are the MP /(c) of these areas /(d) no error.
- Q.61.** (a) Wearing his round spectacle, /(b) the professor delivered an engaging /(c) lecture to the students /(d) no error.
- Q.62.** (a) A series of lecture on /(b)advanced topics will be delivered by /(c)renowned experts during the academic conference /(d) no error.
- Q.63.** (a) A teacher in him emerged /(b) when he saw the kids struggling, /(c) and he stepped in to offer guidance. /(d) no error.
- Q.64.** (a) The soaps, infused with /(b) natural ingredients, left her skin /(c) feeling refreshed and nourished /(d) no error.
- Q.65.** (a) She applied a thin layer of /(b) filths on the antique furniture to give it an aged appearance, /(c)a popular technique among restoration artists. /(d) no error.
- Q.66.** (a) His deep understanding of current event /(b)allowed him to navigate through the complex /(c) landscape of international politics. /(d) no error.

- Q.67.** (a) The three thousand hens lay about thirty/(b) dozens of eggs every month /(c) which I sell in the market to make a living./(d) No error
- Q.68.** (a) I can do only /(b) your work, /(c) not somebody's else /(d) no error.
- Q.69.** (a) The Earth's atmosphere /(b) protects us from /(c) harmful solar radiation /(d) no error.
- Q.70.** (a) The good in the store /(b) ranged from clothing and electronics /(c) to household items /(d) no error.
- Q.71.** (a) The sand of the Sahara /(b) stretch for miles, creating a /(c) vast desert landscape. /(d) no error.
- Q.72.** (a) The cultural customs of /(b) exchanging gifts during festivals /(c) was deeply ingrained in their society /(d) no error.
- Q.73.** (a) The Johnsons /(b) were seen at the local park, /(c) spending quality time together /(d) no error.
- Q.74.** (a) The scientist recorded a crucial /(b) data in the experiment, contributing valuable /(c) information to the study./(d) no error.
- Q.75.** (a) The meeting agenda outlined /(b) the key topics to be discussed, ensuring a /(c) focused and productive session /(d) no error.
- Q.76.** (a) The advocate presented /(b) his case eloquently in the courtroom, /(c) persuading the jury /(d) no error.
- Q.77.** (a) The businesses of creating handcrafted /(b) chocolates turned into a sweet success, /(c) attracting customers from all over./(d) no error.
- Q.78.** (a) The cluster of kittens, with /(b) their playful antics, quickly became the /(c) center of attention in the neighborhood./(d) no error.
- Q.79.** (a) She carefully arranged /(b) a bunch of flowers, selecting /(c) each bloom with artistic precision./(d) no error.
- Q.80.** (a) She confidently walked into the room, /(b) wearing high heel that accentuated her posture and /(c) added a touch of elegance to her ensemble./(d) no error.
- Q.81.** (a) The hurricane caused significant /(b) damage to the coastal areas, destroying /(c) homes and infrastructure./(d) no error
- Q.82.** (a) The clerk diligently organized/(b) the files on their desk, /(c) ensuring efficiency in the office./(d) no error.
- Q.83.** (a) The teacher was impressed with the /(b) congregation of students who actively /(c) participated in the classroom discussion./(d) no error
- Q.84.** (a) The Brown always bring /(b) homemade treats to the /(c) community events /(d) no error.
- Q.85.** (a) Their lodging, nestled in the heart /(b) of the countryside, offered a peaceful retreat /(c)away from the bustling city /(d) no error.
- Q.86.** (a) The archaeological site revealed /(b) the remain of an ancient civilization, offering /(c) insights into its culture and lifestyle /(d) no error.
- Q.87.** (a) The school curriculum emphasizes the importance /(b) of social study, encouraging students to /(c) explore diverse cultures and societies.
- Q.88.** (a) The insurance company /(b) compensated the policyholder for /(c) the damage incurred during the storm./(d) no error.
- Q.89.** (a) The prisoner /(b) wore heavy irons /(c) on his wrists and ankles./(d) no error.
- Q.90.** (a) The chef skillfully prepared an omelet /(b) using a fresh ova, creating /(c) a delightful breakfast dish /(d) no error.
- Q.91.** (a) Wordsworth's poetries is characterized/(b) by his description of the beauty/(c) of Nature./(d) no error
- Q.92.** (a) "Please convey my best/(b) regard to the Boss", the receptionist said to the peon/(c) of the Manager./(d) no error
- Q.93.** (a) When he returned from Saudi Arab,/(b) he informed me that he had come here/(c) to do an urgent works./(d) no error
- Q.94.** (a) This type of exercise/(b) is very helpful to the students preparing for the SSC CGL/(c) Examination at Pinnacle./(d) no error

- Q.95.** (a) "There are only certain boy/(b) that are sincere and they can do well in the examinations."/ (c) said the class teacher./ (d) no error
- Q.96.** (a) "I have never seen such a lovely spectacles/(b) ever before", said/(c) the passer-by./ (d) No error
- Q.97.** (a) I do my best but I don't know why/(b) I do not get the desired/(c) mark in the examination / (d) no error
- Q.98.** (a) You are among those luckiest man who/(b) get name and fame not by/(c) labour but by chance./ (d) no error
- Q.99.** (a) Not to speak of failure/(b) even an accident/(c) could not affect his high spirits./ (d) no error
- Q.100.** (a) "I don't know about his whereabouts,/(b) do you?"/(c) he said to me./ (d) no error
- Q.101.** (a) It is harmful to take cupsful/(b) of coffee/(c) five times a day./ (d) no error
- Q.102.** (a) The present datas show that the birth rate/(b) has fallen down but not/(c) to the level of satisfaction./ (d) no error
- Q.103.** (a) He said that he always kept in his pocket/(b) a bundle of one hundred/(c) rupees notes./ (d) no error
- Q.104.** (a) Running a five-stars hotel requires more/(b) money than what we have in/(c) our bank./ (d) No error
- Q.105.** (a) She gave me some informations/(b) I had been waiting for/(c) for the previous two months./ (d) no error
- Q.106.** (a) Your advices are the sign of your/(b) dirty mind and/ (c) unacceptable approach./ (d) no error
- Q.107.** (a) Cyclone is a natural phenomenon/(b) and nobody can/(c) stop it, for sure./ (d) no error
- Q.108.** (a) My uncle gave him a home work/(b) and advised him to read it/(c) at night./ (d) no error
- Q.109.** (a) The sheafs of the plants were too heavy/(b) for me to/(c) carry on the head./ (d) no error
- Q.110.** (a) All the Chiefs Ministers are responsible for the/(b) miserable condition of their/(c) states./ (d) no error
- Q.111.** (a) Three dozens bananas/(b) have been/(c) sold by me./ (d) no error
- Q.112.** (a) We believe that a two-miles walk/(b) always keeps us/(c) healthy and fresh./ (d) no error
- Q.113.** (a) "Language consists of several stratum",/(b) said the teacher in his lecture on Language/(c) to the students./ (d) no error
- Q.114.** (a) All his sister-in-laws are invited/(b) to attend the party/(c) on the eve of new year./ (d) no error
- Q.115.** (a) A readymade cloths shop/(b) has opened in the locality/ (c) near the crossroads./ (d) no error
- Q.116.** (a) The wall of this building is/(b) fifty foot high and its paintings/(c) are very nice./ (d) no error
- Q.117.** (a) If a student needs advice about carrier,/(b) he should visit/(c) Pinnacle Institute./ (d) no error
- Q.118.** (a) The beautiful surrounding of the fort/(b) attracted a large number of tourists/(c) coming from abroad./ (d) no error
- Q.119.** (a) His means are very limited/(b) even then/(c) we have seen him happy./ (d) no error
- Q.120.** (a) He uses a fine quality of oil/(b) so his hairs are/(c) black and attractive./ (d) no error

Answers With Explanation :-

Sol.1.(c) Replace 'cupsful' with 'cupfuls'. Nouns ending with 'ful' are made plural by putting 's' after 'ful'.

Sol.2.(b) Replace 'millions' with 'million'. The noun 'million' is used as singular when used after a numeral.

Sol.3.(b) Replace 'pair' with 'pairs'. Pair, dozen, thousand etc. are written in plural form when these words are used with Indefinite countable nouns like dozens of men, thousands of people, many pairs of socks, etc.

Sol.4.(a) Replace 'deaf' with ' the deaf' . 'The deaf' represents the whole community of deafs.

Sol.5.(a) Replace 'book's cover' with 'the cover of the book'. For non-living things, we use 'of' in place of apostrophe s.

Sol.6.(b) Replace 'is' with 'are'. The noun 'scissors' is plural and a plural verb is used with it.

Sol.7.(b) Replace 'have' with 'has'. If we use a preposition after a noun and the same noun is repeated after the preposition, both the nouns should be in singular, and a singular verb will be used.

Sol.8.(b) Replace 'summon' with 'summons'. 'Summons' is a singular noun and a singular verb is used with it.

Sol.9.(a) Replace 'play' with 'plays'. The name of the subject ending with 's' appears as plural but they are singular nouns and a singular verb is used with them.

Sol.10.(a) Replace 'people' with 'peoples'. 'People' is a plural noun and never takes s /es. But when it describes the meaning of race, nation or tribes, the use of 'peoples' is absolutely correct. 'Peoples' is a countable noun.

Sol.11.(a) Replace 'peoples' with 'people'. 'People' is a plural noun and never takes s /es when used in the general sense.

Sol.12.(b) Replace 'half hour' with 'half an hour'. The noun 'half' is always written as 'half a/an noun' or 'a half noun'.

Sol.13.(b) replace 'are' with 'is'. The amount of money, distance and time are considered as singular units and singular verbs are used with them.

Sol.14.(c) Replace 'rooms' with 'room'. When a compound noun(four room) is used before another noun(flat) as an adjective, it is kept in singular form.

Sol.15.(b) Replace 'a' with 'the'. The use of 'the' with any common noun acts as the abstract noun and tells the quality of that noun.

Sol.16.(c) Replace 'olds' with 'old'. 'The old' represents all the old people.

Sol.17.(b) Replace 'has' with 'have'. Police is a plural noun and hence always takes a plural verb.

Sol.18.(a) Replace 'are' with 'is'. The name of any disease is always a singular noun and hence takes a singular verb.

Sol.19.(a) Replace 'everything's beauty' with 'The beauty of everything'. The words 'everything, nothing, something, anything' never takes apostrophes with them.

Sol.20.(a) Replace 'poor' with 'the poor'. 'The poor' represents the whole community of poor.

Sol.21.(b) Replace 'is' with 'are'. 'The brave' represents the whole community of brave.

Sol.22.(c) Replace 'was' with 'were'. 'Knickers' is a plural noun and always takes a plural verb.

Sol.23.(a) Replace 'are' with 'is'. 'News' is a singular noun and always takes a singular verb.

Sol.24.(a) Replace 'require' with 'requires'. The name of any disease is always a singular noun and hence takes a singular verb.

Sol.25.(d) No error. Gentry is a plural noun and hence always takes a plural verb.

Sol.26.(a) Replace 'cities after cities' with 'city after city'. If we use a preposition after a noun and the same noun is repeated after the preposition, both the nouns should be in singular, and a singular verb will be used.

Sol.27.(a) Replace 'men' with 'man'. When a compound noun is used as an adjective, it is kept in singular form.

Sol.28.(a) Replace 'feet' with 'foot'. As feet is the plural form of foot. When a compound noun is used as an adjective, it is kept in singular form.

Sol.29.(a) Replace 'informations' with 'information'. 'Information' is an uncountable noun and hence does not have a plural form.

Sol.30.(c) Replace 'content' with 'contents'. 'Content' means satisfaction while 'contents' is related to subject matter.

Sol.31.(c) Replace 'beauty' with 'beauties'. Beauty is used as a countable as well as uncountable noun. The noun 'beauty' is uncountable when it talks about the beauty of something or person but it is a countable noun when it talks about the features of something or someone.

Sol.32.(b) Replace 'cloths' with 'clothes'. 'Cloth' is a material noun and hence is uncountable. It never takes s/es. But clothes means attire or clad.

Sol.33.(d) No error.

Sol.34.(c) Replace 'are' with 'is'. 'Hair' is an uncountable noun and hence takes a singular verb.

Sol.35.(c) Replace 'are' with 'is'. 'Pair of spectacles' is a singular noun and takes a singular verb.

Sol.36.(c) Replace 'fishes' with 'fish'.

Rule : Be careful with the noun **fish** which is normally used as the same in singular and plural form. But when it talks about the kind or type of fish, it is written as fishes.

Sol.37.(b) Replace 'fruits' with 'fruit'.

Rule : The noun 'fruit' is uncountable when it gives the meaning of food. But it is countable when we talk about the kind or type of fruit.

Sol.38.(c) Replace 'metropolis' with 'metropolitan'.

Rule : 'Metropolis' refers to a large and densely populated industrial and commercial city but 'metropolitan' is the correct term when referring to a person related or connected to a metropolis.

Sol.39.(d) No error. If we use a preposition after a noun and the same noun is repeated after the preposition, both the nouns should be in singular, and a singular verb will be used.

Sol.40.(b) Replace "India" with "India's".

Rule : For common possession, use 's with the final word. But to show the different possession 's is used with all the words.

Sol.41.(c) Replace 'wives' with 'wives'. The plural form of wife is wives.

Sol.42.(c) Replace 'passer-bys' with 'passers-by'. In case of compound nouns, (except the nouns made with man/woman) use root or head word to make it plural.

Sol.43.(c) Replace 'childs' with 'children'. The plural form of child is children.

Sol.44.(b) Replace 'spoonsful' with 'spoonfuls'. Nouns ending with 'ful' are made plural by putting 's' after 'ful'.

Sol.45.(b) Replace 'doctor' with 'doctors'. In case of compound nouns starting with man or woman, both the nouns are made plural.

Sol.46.(a) Replace "Rachna's" with "Rachna". For common possession, use 's with the final word.

Sol.47.(b) Replace "someone's else" with "someone else's". If else is used after 'someone', then 's will be used after else.

Sol.48.(b) Replace "sister's in law" with "sister in law's". A singular compound noun shows possession with an apostrophe + s at the end of the word.

Sol.49.(a) Replace 'peoples' with 'people'. 'People' refers to all the people in a region in the general sense. 'Peoples' is used when referring to different ethnic, cultural or national groups within a region.

Sol.50.(d) No error. The noun 'leader' is used for both Male and Female Genders and is used as **singular** and generally: **he/his/him** are used after it.

Sol.51.(a) Replace 'valuable' with 'valuables'. 'Valuable' is an adjective while 'valuables' refer to items such as money, jewelry or any important documents etc.

Sol.52.(c) Replace 'is' with 'are'. 'Police' is a plural noun and hence always takes a plural verb.

Sol.53.(d) No error.

Sol.54.(c) Replace 'papers' with 'paper'. (Here, paper is a material noun, so it is treated as a singular noun.)

Sol.55.(c) Replace 'irons' with 'iron'. Here, 'iron' is a material noun while irons means a fetter or chain.

Sol.56.(c) Replace 'grounds' with 'ground'. Ground means the solid surface of the earth while grounds means the basis for something.

Sol.57.(b) Replace wit with wit's. "At one's wit's end" is an idiomatic phrase.

Sol.58.(b) Replace arm with arm's. "At an arm's length" is an idiomatic phrase.

Sol.59.(c) Replace 'phenomena' with 'phenomenon'. 'Phenomena' is the plural form of 'phenomenon'.

Sol.60.(b) Replace 'MP' with 'MPs'. The plural form of MP is MPs.

Sol.61.(a) Replace 'spectacle' with 'spectacles'. Spectacles, goggles, binoculars, eyeglasses are always plural and a plural verb is used with them.

Sol.62.(a) Replace 'lecture' with 'lectures'. Here, the sentence talks about multiple lectures so plural form of lecture will be used.

Sol.63.(a) Replace 'a' with 'the'. The use of 'the' with any common noun acts as the abstract noun and hence denotes that quality.

Sol.64.(a) Replace 'soaps' with 'soap'. 'Soap' is an uncountable noun and never takes s/es with it.

Sol.65.(b) Replace 'filths' with 'filth'. 'Filth' is an uncountable noun and never takes s/es with it.

Sol.66.(a) Replace 'event' with 'events'. 'Current events' is a compound noun which is always used in the plural form.

Sol.67.(b) Replace 'dozens of eggs' with 'dozen eggs'. When 'dozen' comes after a numeral noun it is always used as a singular noun.

Sol.68.(c) Replace "somebody's else" with "somebody else's". If 'else' is used after 'somebody', then 's' will be used after 'else'.

Sol.69.(d) no error. Apostrophes can be used after a heavenly or celestial body.

Sol.70.(a) Replace 'good' with 'goods'. 'Goods' means belongings while 'good' is related to beneficial.

Sol.71.(a) Replace 'sand' with 'sands'. 'Sands' means a small desert while 'Sand' is related to a loose granular substance.

Sol.72.(a) Replace 'customs' with 'custom'. 'Custom' means tradition while 'customs' is related to a tax imposed on imports and exports of goods.

Sol.73.(d) no error. 'The + plural surname' denotes a whole family and a plural verb is used with it.

Sol.74.(b) Replace 'data' with 'datum'. 'Data' is the plural form of 'datum'.

Sol.75.(d) no error

Sol.76.(d) no error. The noun 'advocate' is used for both Male and Female Genders and is used as **singular** and generally: **he/his/him** are used after it.

Sol.77.(a) Replace 'businesses' with 'business'. Business is an uncountable noun and hence written in singular form.

Sol.78.(a) Replace 'cluster' with 'litter'. A cluster of stars and a litter of puppies/ pigs/ kittens etc. - fixed group denoting words.

Sol.79.(b) Replace 'bunch' with 'bouquet'. A bouquet of flowers and a bunch of grapes, keys etc. are fixed group denoting words.

Sol.80.(b) Replace 'heel' with 'heels'. 'High heels' is a compound noun which is always used in the plural form.

Sol.81.(d) no error.

Sol.82.(b) Replace 'their' with 'his'. The noun 'clerk' is used for both Male and Female Genders and is used as **singular** and generally: **he/his/him** are used after it.

Sol.83.(d) no error.

Sol.84.(a) Replace 'brown' with 'browns'. 'The + plural surname' denotes a whole family and a plural verb is used with it.

Sol.85.(a) Replace 'lodging' with 'lodgings'. 'Lodgings' is always written in plural form and takes a plural verb with it.

Sol.86.(b) Replace 'remain' with 'remains'. 'Remains' is always written in plural form and takes a plural verb with it.

Sol.87.(b) Replace 'study' with 'studies'. 'Social studies' is a compound noun which is always used in the plural form.

Sol.88.(c) Replace 'damage' with 'damages'. 'Damage' means physical harm while damages refers to a sum of money claimed or awarded in compensation for a loss or an injury.

Sol.89.(d) no error. Irons means fetters or chains.

Sol.90.(b) Replace 'ova' with 'ovum'. The plural form of ovum is ova.

Sol.91.(a) Replace "poetries" with "poetry".

Rule : These nouns are used in singular form only and they are uncountable form only.

Sol.92.(b) Replace "regard" with "regard". Regard is a verb and regards are best wishes used to express friendliness in greetings.

Sol.93.(c) Replace "works" by "work". "Works" means the compositions of a writer, painter etc.

Sol.94.(d) No error.

Sol.95.(a) "There are" indicates that it is plural, so "boys" will be used instead of "boy".

Sol.96.(a) Replace "spectacles" with "spectacle". Here, we are talking about the view/event which the speaker is looking at. Therefore, spectacle will be used.

Sol.97.(c) Replace "mark" with "marks". Mark means to note something. Marks is what one scores in an exam.

Sol.98.(a) Replace "man" with "men". "Those" will be followed by a plural noun/pronoun.

Sol.99.(c) Replace "spirits" with "spirit". Spirit means enthusiasm.

Sol.100.(a) Replace "whereabout" with "whereabouts". "Whereabouts" means the place where someone or something is.

Sol.101.(a) Replace "cupsful" with "cupfuls". (Already covered)

Sol.102.(a) Replace "datas" with "data" which is the correct word. The correct plural form of the word is data.

Sol.103.(c) Replace "one hundred rupees notes" with "one hundred rupee notes"

Rule : Words like dozen, score, pair, hundred, million when used after a numeral are used as singular.

Sol.104.(a) Replace "five-stars" with "five-star".

Rule : Hyphenated noun: Expressions such as a ten-rupee note, a two-mile walk, five-year old child, a three-day workshop, a twenty-man committee, are treated as singular. We don't pluralize them. Hyphenated words are not pluralized.

Sol.105.(a) Replace "informations" with "information".

Rule : These nouns are used in singular form only and they are uncountable form only.

Sol.106.(a) Replace "advices" with "advice". Advice does not have a plural.

Rule : These nouns are used in singular form only and they are uncountable form only.

Sol.107.(d) No error.

Sol.108.(a) Remove "a" before homework. Homework is an uncountable noun.

Sol.109.(a) Replace "sheaf" with "sheaves". The plural of sheaf is sheaves.

Sol.110.(a) Replace "Chiefs Ministers" with "Chief Ministers". To make plural forms of compound words, we add "-s" after the main word.

Sol.111.(a) Replace "dozens" with "dozen".

Rule : Words like dozen, score, pair, hundred, million when used after a numeral are used as singular.

Sol.112.(a) Replace "a two miles walk" with "a two mile walk".

Rule : Hyphenated noun: Expressions such as a ten-rupee note, a two-mile walk, a five-year old child, are treated as

singular. We don't pluralize them. Hyphenated words are not pluralized.

Sol.113.(a) Replace "stratum" with "strata". The correct plural form of the word is "strata".

Sol.114.(a) Replace "sister-in-laws" with "sisters-in-law". To make plural forms of compound words, we add "-s" after the main word.

Sol.115.(a) Replace "cloths" with "clothes". Cloth is fabric or material formed by weaving, knitting etc which is unstitched. Its plural is "cloths". "Clothes" are stitched fabric that are worn. So, it will be available at a readymade clothes shop.

Sol.116.(b) Replace "fifty foot" with "fifty feet". Foot is singular and feet is plural.

Sol.117.(a) Replace "carrier" by "career". Career is an occupation undertaken for a significant period of a person's life.

Sol.118.(a) Replace "surrounding" with "surroundings". Surrounding is a verb and surroundings is a noun.

Sol.119.(d) No error

Sol.120.(b) Replace "hairs" with "hair". These nouns are used in singular form only and they are uncountable form only.

Rule : These nouns are used in singular form only and they are uncountable form only.

search on TG-@freepdfhall